



Today, I want to talk about...

Working with others



Agenda

- Listening: A presentation
- Vocabulary: Structuring a presentation
- Grammar: Narrative tenses
- Speaking: A short presentation



Discussion

1. Complete the list of elements that make a good presentation with the words in the boxes.

appearance | contact | humour | knowledge | talk

- a) a well-structured
- b) thorough subject
- c) a smart and professional
- d) a good sense of
- e) good eye

attitude | language | preparation | visuals | voice

- a) an enthusiastic
- b) a strong
- c) a creative use of
- d) expressive body
- e) careful

2. **With a partner, discuss the elements in 1 and rank them in order of importance.**
Use the phrases in the box in your discussion.

- Another important thing is ...
- ... can make a real difference.
- I think ... is pretty important too.
- It helps if ..., but it's not essential.
- What you need most of all is ...
- You don't need ..., as long as ...



Lektor

Structure

The following expressions help you to give a clear structure to a presentation.

Complete them with the prepositions in the box.

about | back | for | of | off | on | to | up

- a) To start _____, then, ...
- b) To move _____ to my next point, ...
- c) To go _____ to what I was saying, ...
- d) To turn now _____ a different matter, ...
- e) To say a bit more _____ that, ...
- f) To give you an example _____ what I mean, ...
- g) To digress _____ a moment, ...
- h) To sum _____, then, ...

Which of the expressions are used to:

- return to an important point? ☐
- repeat the main points? ☐
- talk about something unconnected? ☐
- begin the presentation? ☐
- expand a point? ☐ ☐
- change the subject? ☐ ☐



Lektor

Past tenses

Past Simple

Used for completed actions in the past, often with a specific time reference.

Examples:

- She **attended** a workshop on time management last week.
- The company **launched** a new product in 2022.

Past Continuous

Used for actions that were ongoing at a specific time in the past or for background actions.

Examples:

- I **was reviewing** the candidates' resumes when the call came in.
- They **were working** on a marketing strategy all afternoon.

Past Perfect

Used to describe an action that was completed before another action or time in the past.

Examples:

- By the time she arrived, the team **had already finished** the presentation.
- He **had completed** the training before he started the new role.

Past Perfect Continuous

Used to emphasize the duration of an action that was ongoing before another action or time in the past

Examples:

- They **had been negotiating** for hours before they reached an agreement.
- I **had been preparing** for the meeting all morning when it was canceled.

- The **past perfect** contrasts with the **past simple**, which describes events in the order they happened (e.g., *She arrived, and then the team finished the presentation*).
- Past perfect focuses on the completion: *She **had written** the email before the deadline.*
- Past perfect continuous emphasizes the process: *She **had been writing** the email for two hours when the power went out.*



Answer key

It **was** a busy week for our client's digital payments platform. Every day, the system **was processing** millions of transactions and everything **seemed** stable. Suddenly, however, failures **started** to appear. Within 48 hours, customers **reported** delays, declined payments and strange security alerts.

While the platform **was handling** peak traffic, three problems **emerged** at the same time: transactions **were delayed**, payments **failed** because of timeouts, and false alerts **were blocking** legitimate purchases. By then, Endava **had already assembled** a team of 22 engineers who **were working** around the clock to diagnose the issue.

The investigation revealed that the problem **did not come** from the cloud provider. Instead, it **was traced** back to a legacy backend component that **had not been updated** for 14 months. Because of this, unprocessed transactions **were piling up** and the system **was generating** inaccurate fraud alerts.

To stabilise the platform, the engineers **isolated** the misconfiguration, **replayed** failed transactions, and **restored** normal capacity. They also **resynchronised** backend services across environments. Within hours, performance **returned** to normal and customers **noticed** that payments **were going** through again.

After the crisis, Endava **set** new objectives. The company **planned** to scale the platform into three more markets and **deployed** an AI-driven fraud detection layer. These steps **formed** part of a long-term roadmap that **aimed** to reduce risks and support growth.

Looking back, the graph of transaction failures clearly showed how the system **had had** serious spikes before the fix, but stability **followed** quickly after the intervention.



That's all, folks!

